

The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

SU V1 V2 V3 V4



Mostly cloudy 69/60 • Tomorrow: T-storms 73/52 **B6**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

SATURDAY, MARCH 15, 2025 • \$4



DAN AGOSTINI/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Fernanda Maciel with her son and son-in-law on her coffee farm in Pedregulho, Brazil. In 2022, she lost 90 percent of her harvest to frost, and this year, she faced severe drought tied to global warming. With coffee prices so high, what's left of her crop is threatened by thieves.

Jittery over java? So are Brazil's farmers.

Soaring prices here have a lot to do with a changing climate in the world's largest coffee producer

BY MARINA DIAS AND TERRENCE MCCOY

FRANCA, BRAZIL — To understand why coffee now costs a record \$7 per pound in a typical American supermarket, take a bumpy dirt road into the hills of southeastern Brazil, past lines of purple-flowered trees and into the parched coffee fields of Augusto Rodrigues Alves.

As the farmer paced his desiccated land on a recent morning, his phone kept ringing.

Normally, these types of calls from buyers would be welcome for Rodrigues Alves, 27, who exports artisanal coffee to the United States and supplies Starbucks. But not this year, and not after this



harvest.

"I don't have any coffee," he said hurriedly. Then, to another caller: "I'm out of stock, nothing, zero."

Rodrigues Alves's dilemma illustrates the precariousness and limits of global coffee production in a quickly warming world. Extreme temperatures and severe droughts are ravaging Brazil, the world's largest coffee producer, and taking a heavy toll on local harvests. Global demand, meanwhile, continues to surge, particularly in China. Now a beverage that has always been a daily staple, affordable to anyone in need of a boost, has started to become

SEE **COFFEE** ON **A10**

If peace comes, Putin may face the ire of 'turbopatriots'

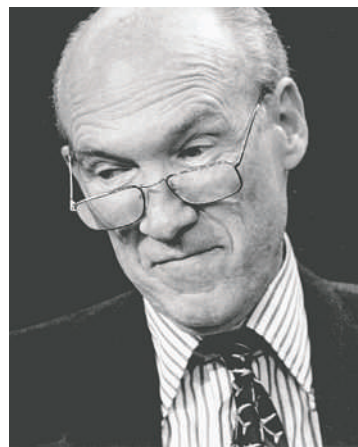
Thawing relations with U.S. contradict his story of a war with the West

BY FRANCESCA EBEL

MOSCOW — In the wake of the Trump administration's dramatic pivot toward Moscow, Russia's influential ultra-patriots are scrambling to make sense of the sudden thaw with the nation's bitterest enemy.

In the three years since the full-scale invasion of Ukraine,

Alan K. Simpson 1931-2025



RAY LUSTIG/THE WASHINGTON POST

The Republican from Wyoming was a towering presence in the U.S. Senate — and a force for compromise. **Obituary, B4**

many in Russian society, especially those actively engaged in the war, have been deeply inculcated by the ideological narrative advanced by President Vladimir Putin and Russian nationalists that the country is fighting an existential war with a "collective West" led by the United States.

The war has given enormous public exposure to what's known as Russia's "Z community" — pro-war volunteers, military bloggers and ultranationalists who want to see a total subjugation of Ukraine. Many interviewed by The Washington Post said they would not accept a peace settlement unless it entailed the removal of Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky and a change of power in Kyiv.

As negotiations between Russia, Ukraine and the United States inch forward, Putin will have to keep careful tabs on this vocal (and well-armed) segment of society, which has grown stronger in the course of the war and at one point even erupted into open revolt with mercenary boss Yevgeniy Prigozhin's short-lived mutiny.

The "turbopatriots" have played an important role throughout the conflict. Many fought on the front lines and were rewarded with an increased social status in wartime Russian society. For decades regarded by the Kremlin as a volatile source of potential opposition, these ultranationalist figures were

SEE **RUSSIA** ON **A8**

G-7: Leaders overlook Trump's insults and find agreements. **A9**



KENT NISHIMURA/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Oz testifies before Senate committee

Mehmet Oz, President Donald Trump's nominee to lead the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services, testifies before the Senate Finance Committee on Friday. He avoided promising to oppose cuts to Medicaid and was grilled about treatments he's promoted on "The Dr. Oz Show." **Story, A4**

After L.A. fires, scorched lots are selling fast

BY BRIANNA SACKS AND REIS THEBAULT

ALTADENA, CALIF. — Hugo Dalinger knew he couldn't go back. Not after a wall of flames swallowed his bright-white Altadena home during the January firestorm that took out most of his town. But he needed money to start over, so he reached out to a friend and veteran real estate

agent for help.

Ramiro Rivas was skeptical. He grew up around Altadena and has sold hundreds of properties in 21 years — but a fire-scarred lot was new. He put the 10,500-square-foot, ash-filled parcel up for sale on Feb. 3, pitching it as an "incredible canvas for a custom-built estate."

"Opportunities like this where privacy, natural beauty, and lim-

itless potential converge are truly rare," he wrote, with no mention of the disaster. "Property sold as-is. Cash offers only."

He was surprised how fast offers came in. In nine days, Rivas closed Altadena's first post-fire residential land sale. The Dalingers now had \$603,000 for a down payment on a smaller home in nearby Pasadena. Soon

SEE **FIRES** ON **A12**

At Justice, Trump gives speech fit for a campaign

BY PERRY STEIN, JEREMY ROEBUCK AND DEREK HAWKINS

President Donald Trump delivered an unusual, campaign-style speech at Justice Department headquarters Friday, heavy with grievance and meandering from such topics as Al Capone to allegations of judicial corruption as he defied the distance that has traditionally existed between the White House and the federal law enforcement agency.

The president laid out his tough-on-crime vision, which includes mass deportations and prosecuting cartels to remove fentanyl from American streets. He repeated a hallmark mantra of his 2024 presidential campaign, vowing to end what he called the weaponization of the Justice Department.

But the speech — billed as one focused on law and order — was also sprinkled with tangents and misleading claims about immigration and crime in this country. Trump declared that he would keep FBI headquarters in downtown Washington instead of relocating it to a not-yet-constructed campus in suburban Maryland, a plan that has been in the works for decades and won final approval in 2023.

SEE **TRUMP** ON **A4**

Layoffs: Cuts quickly take a toll on the Education Department. **A6**

IN THE NEWS

Helicopter routes at DCA Restrictions around Reagan National Airport put in place after January's deadly collision are now permanent, the FAA said. **A4**

Art of the heart A Maryland man is turning pieces of scrap metal into glowing pink messages of love and hope. **B1**

THE NATION **Disability advocates** fear that a lawsuit could cut services to millions of people. **A3** **Intelligence chief** Tulsi Gabbard said leaks to the media will be aggressively investigated. **A5**

THE WORLD **Syrians fled** to Lebanon after violence this month between Alawites and government forces. **A7** **Mark Carney** was sworn in as Canada's prime minister amid U.S. trade tensions. **A9**

THE ECONOMY **A crypto company** is in disarray after it was revealed to have been co-founded by a hacker who has been accused of sexual assaults. **A11** **Rights groups** and U.S. lawmakers asked a judge to open secret proceeding on Apple's U.K. encryption case. **A12**

THE REGION **Federal workers** are scrambling to comply with return-to-office orders that have some moving hundreds of miles on short notice. **B1** **Diane Rehm**, 88, will leave WAMU on May 2 after decades as a presence on Washington's airwaves. **B1**

STYLE **On London's** West End stages, stars of movies and TV shows are taking a bow. **C1** **SPORTS** **D.C. United's** Rida Zouhir faces a challenge as he fasts during the daytime while observing the Muslim holy month of Ramadan. **D1**

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